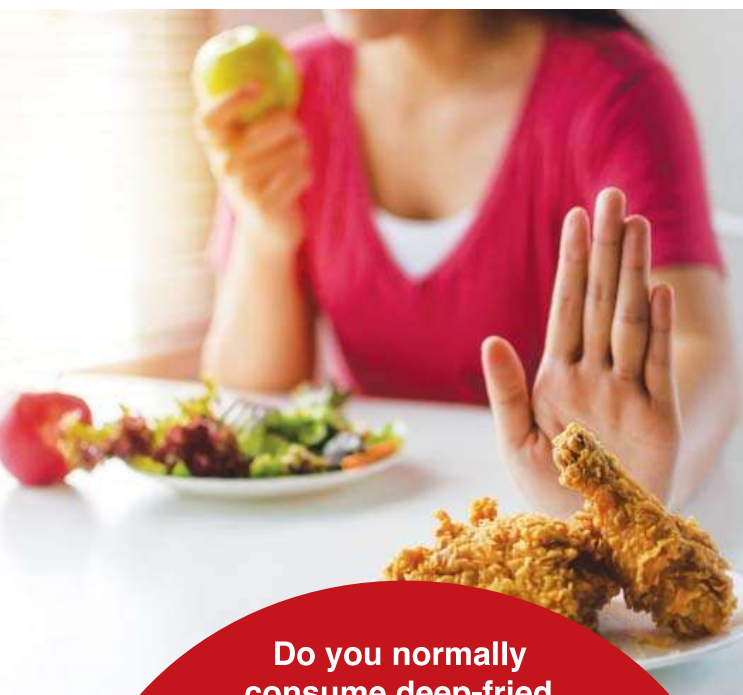


Consume foods prepared with less sugar, oil and salt



Do you normally consume deep-fried foods and sugary drinks and salty snacks in between meals? Be aware of hidden sugar, oil and salt in these foods!

Excessive intake of fats and oils, sugar and salt can result in higher risk of chronic diseases such as obesity, hypertension, diabetes, cardiovascular diseases and cancers.

Sugar

Contrary to popular belief, sugar does not cause diabetes. It is excessive intake of sugar that can result in high calorie intake that may lead to weight gain when coupled with sedentary lifestyle. Over a period of time, this may lead to overweight and obesity and will in turn increase the risk of getting NCDs such as diabetes, heart disease and cancer.

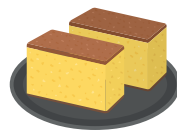
Examples of high-sugar foods and drinks & tips to reduce sugar



≈ 27 g / 5 teaspoons of sugar

Always choose plain water

Teh tarik (250 ml)



≈ 25 g / 5 teaspoons of sugar

Limit sweet local kueh that are high in sugar

Bingkka ubi kayu (96 g)



≈ 19 g / 4 teaspoons of sugar

Replace sugary desserts with fresh fruits

Chocolate cake (130 g)



≈ 40-100 g / 8-20 teaspoons of sugar

Opt for lower sugar varieties

Sugar-sweetened packaged drinks

Recommendation

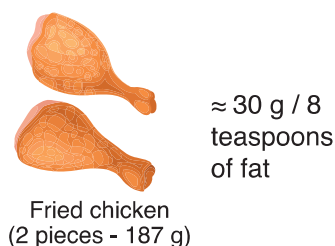
Less than 10 teaspoons daily. Taking one glass of *teh tarik* and one piece of *bingka ubi kayu* or chocolate cake would have already reached the recommended amount.

Note: Be mindful that carbohydrates also break down into sugar in the body. Excessive consumption of starchy foods can also lead to unnecessary calorie intake. Hence, consume these in moderation by practising the Malaysian Healthy Plate: only a quarter of your plate should contain carbohydrate foods.

Oils and fats

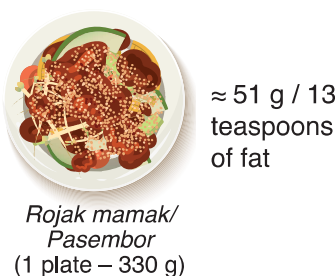
Oils and fats contribute two times more calories than carbohydrate and protein. Hence, excessive intake can result in unintended weight gain, which can lead to NCDs such as heart disease.

Examples of high-fat foods & tips to reduce oil/fat



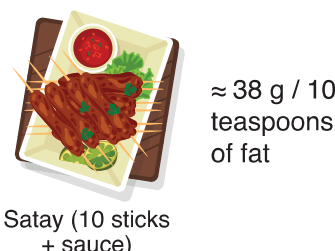
≈ 30 g / 8
teaspoons
of fat

Modify
cooking
method
to reduce
excessive
use of oil.
Try grilling
or use an
air-fryer



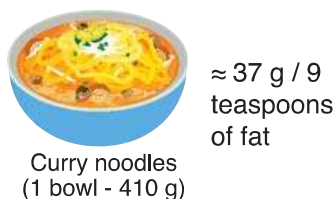
≈ 51 g / 13
teaspoons
of fat

Reduce
deep-fried
and batter-
fried foods



≈ 38 g / 10
teaspoons
of fat

Trim all visible
fats of meat
and remove
chicken
skin from
poultry before
cooking



≈ 37 g / 9
teaspoons
of fat

Consume
less gravy as
this is high
in oil

Recommendation

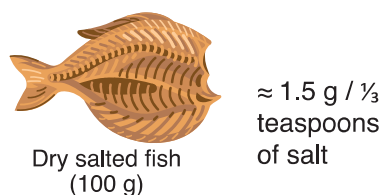
Not more than ~15 teaspoons daily. Having a bowl of curry noodles for lunch and 10 sticks of satay with sauce for dinner would have already exceeded the recommended intake of oil/fat for that day!

Salt



High salt intake can lead to hypertension and may cause stroke or heart disease.

Examples of high-salt foods & tips to reduce salt



≈ 1.5 g / $\frac{1}{3}$
teaspoons
of salt

Choose
foods with
lower salt
or sodium
content



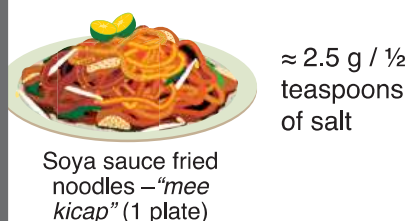
≈ 3.5 g / $\frac{3}{4}$
teaspoons
of salt

Do not use
the whole
packet of
seasoning



≈ 1.5 g / $\frac{1}{3}$
teaspoons
of salt

Limit the
amount
of salt,
sauces and
seasonings
in cooking



≈ 2.5 g / $\frac{1}{2}$
teaspoons
of salt

Opt for
dishes with
lower salt and
sauces when
eating out

Recommendation

Reduce salt consumption to less than 5 g or 1 teaspoon per day.

Consuming a plate of "mee kicap" would have reached half of the salt recommended intake. Try to reduce foods prepared with sauces and opt for those prepared with spices & natural flavours.